MIL-L-13790(Ord)
17 November 1954
Superseding
SAPD-124A
14 May 1954

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

LINKS, METALLIC, 30-MM

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope.- This specification covers metallic links intended to hold 30-mm. ammunition in the form of flexible belts.

1.2 Classification.- Links shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1):

Type I - Link, Metallic, 30mm, T64E2.

Type II - Link, Metallic, 30mm, T84.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications, standards, drawings and publications, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

UU-T-111 - Tape; Paper, Gummed (Sealing and Securing).
LLL-B-631- Boxes; Fiber Corrugated (for Domestic Shipment).
LLL-B-636- Boxes, Fiber, Solid, (for Domestic Shipment).

MILITARY

MIL-P-116- Preservation, Methods of.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T02:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MIL-P-3420 - Packaging Materials, Volatile Corrosion Inhibitor Treated.
MIL-V-8574 - Volatile Corrosion Inhibitors in Preservation and Packaging; Use of.
MIL-W-13855 Weapons, Small Arms, General Specification for

STANDARDS

MILITARY
MIL-STD-105 -Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 -Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWINGS

ORDNANCE CORPS
D7266812 - Link, Metallic, 30mm, T64E2.
D7266848 - Link, Metallic, 30mm, T84

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Design and manufacture.- Links shall conform to the materials, dimensions, tolerance limits, heat treatment, degree of surface roughness, and final protective finish specified on Drawings D7266812, D7266848, or other approved drawings as applicable. All surfaces shall be smooth and finished in accordance with Specification 52-0-1.

3.2 Functioning.- Links shall function properly when assembled into flexible belts (see 4.3.2).

3.3 Hardness.- Links shall be heat-treated to the hardness specified on the applicable drawing.

3.4 Cartridge stripping.- When tested as prescribed in 4.3.4, the load required to strip a cartridge from a link from rear to front shall be within the limits specified on the applicable drawings.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T02:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5 Shock resistance.- Belts of assembled links shall not be rendered unsuitable for use when subjected to the catenary test specified in 4.3.5.

3.6 Workmanship.- Links shall be free of burrs, cracks, malformations, and other defects which may affect serviceability, functioning, or appearance.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Sampling.

4.1.1 Lot.- Unless otherwise specified, a lot shall consist of all links produced by a manufacturing facility during one production day, provided that production is more than 8,000 links. Should the production for one day be less than 8,001 links, the production of two or more days shall be used to form the lot.

4.1.2 Inspection sample.- The inspector may subject all or part of any lot to such inspection as he deems necessary to determine compliance with this specification.

4.1.3 Test samples.- Unless otherwise specified, the number of test samples shall be as specified for each test.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 Contractor's inspection.- The contractor shall maintain an adequate system of processing, inspection, and lot identification. Only such lots which meet the requirements of this specification shall be submitted for final Government inspection.

4.2.2 Procedure.- Links shall be gaged and visually inspected to determine compliance with the dimensional and workmanship requirements. Before final acceptance of any lot, the inspector shall make whatever final inspection deemed necessary to assure that the links have undergone all inspection and tests prescribed therefor, and that they have been prepared for shipment as required by section 5.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 Contractor's responsibility.- Unless otherwise

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T02:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

specified, all tests specified herein shall be performed by the contractor under the supervision of a Government inspector.

4.3.2 Functioning test.- On each contract, 100 links taken at random from the first lot shall be forwarded to Springfield Armory, Springfield 1, Massachusetts for functioning test and approval prior to quantity production. One hundred links from each month's production thereafter shall be forwarded for functioning test and determination of the quality of the product being delivered to the Government. The monthly samples shall be taken from lots found satisfactory in other tests at the rate of 25 per quarter of the monthly production period.

4.3.3 Hardness test.- Hardness tests shall be made on test samples from each heat treatment batch. Samples shall be selected in accordance with the double sampling plan of Standard MIL-STD-105. Sample size code letter J shall be used regardless of batch size. Batch acceptance shall be based on an acceptable quality level of 0.65 percent defective. A batch shall consist of links heat-treated in a batch-type furnace at one charge or in a continuous-type furnace during an uninterrupted period extending over not more than one production day. Tests shall be made after heat treatment and prior to phosphating.

4.3.4 Cartridge stripping test.

4.3.4.1 Sampling procedure.- Test samples shall be selected in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-105 at inspection level II with lot acceptance for cartridge stripping based on an acceptable quality level of 1.0 percent defective.

4.3.4.2 Test procedure.- A Government standard dummy cartridge shall be assembled in each link to be tested. The link shall be held rigidly in a manner that shall permit application of the test load. Load shall be applied without impact to the base and along the longitudinal center line of the cartridge.

4.3.4.2.1 Alternate method.- Links may be tested for cartridge stripping by use of an approved bar or plug in lieu of a cartridge providing suitable correlations in load requirements are made.

4.3.5 Catenary test.- The catenary test shall be conducted in accordance with the requirements listed on the

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T02:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

applicable drawings and in this specification. Links, taken at random by the inspector from each lot, shall be assembled with Government standard dummy cartridges into 10 belts, and each belt shall be tested for shock resistance. Dummy cartridges shall be packed to have an individual weight equal to that of a Government standard 30-mm. practice cartridge. Belt shall be suspended, with open side of links down, between two rigid supports. The belt shall be secured to the supports at the end links and allowed to hang freely so as to form an unobstructed loop. The end links shall be on the same horizontal plane. The center (lowest point) of the loop shall be raised the required distance and allowed to fall. Belt shall then be examined for broken or damaged links, partial or complete separation of links, and evidence of failure of any link to retain cartridge.

4.4 Reinspection and retests.- Links rejected individually or by lots because of inspection or test shall be returned to the contractor. After conditioning they may be resubmitted for inspection or test in which failure occurred and such other inspection and tests as the inspector may consider necessary.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Domestic shipment immediate use.- Not applicable.

5.2 Domestic shipment limited storage.

5.2.1 Preservation.

5.2.1.1 Uncontaminated links.- Links that go directly to the packaging operations after the oil application phase of the final protective finish may be preserved and packed without cleaning, drying, and recoiling.

5.2.1.2 Contaminated links.- Links subjected to intervening handling after application of final protective finish and links contaminated with shop coatings, dirt, or other foreign matter shall be cleaned, dried, and recoiled prior to preservation.

5.2.1.2.1 Cleaning.- Links shall be cleaned by process C-2 of Specification MIL-P-116.

5.2.1.2.2 Drying.- Links shall be dried in accordance with any procedure of Specification MIL-P-116.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T02:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.1.2.3 Reoiling.- The supplementary oil coating of the final protective finish shall be reapplied to the links, and excess oil shall be thoroughly removed by draining or centrifuging.

5.2.1.3 Preservative method.- Links shall be preserved with light duty volatile corrosion inhibitor (VCI) material conforming to Specification MIL-P-3420, applied as specified in 5.2.2.1 and in accordance with Specification MIL-V-8574.

5.2.2 Packaging.

5.2.2.1 Unit package.- Links shall be packaged in a fiberboard box conforming to either Specification LLL-B-631 or LLL-B-636 in uniform quantities of not less than 250 nor more than 400 links per box. The links shall be packaged on end in two layers of equal quantities with a fiberboard pad between the layers. Fiberboard pads shall also be used at the bottom and top of the box. The faces of the fiberboard pads and the inside of the box shall be lined with VCI material in a manner that will keep the links from direct contact with the fiberboard. The box shall be sealed along all open seams with 3-inch gummed tape conforming to class 2 of Specification UU-T-111.

5.2.3 Packing.- The unit package specified in 5.2.2.1 shall serve as the shipping container.

5.2.4 Marking.- Each shipping container shall be clearly marked in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-129. The permanent marking shall be composed of the following information:

Stock number
Nomenclature and Drawing number
Quantity
Packaged by (name and address of prime contractor)
Contract or Order number
Date packed (day, month, and year)
Method of preservation
Packed for limited storage

Example:

X000-0000000
Link, Metallic, 30mm, T64E2, D7266812
400
John Doe Co, Springfield Mass
DA-19-075-ORD-58
Date Pkd 29 Jan 54
VCI-Code A1
PACKED FOR LIMITED STORAGE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T02:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.3 Oversea shipment or extended domestic storage.- Not applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type required. (See 1.2.)

6.2 This specification, if applicable, may be used for procurement of other 30mm. links not mentioned herein.

6.3 The methods and materials specified in section 5 are intended for use in the preparation for delivery of links from a manufacturer to ammunition loading plants and for short-term storage.

Notice. This specification, together with specifications and drawings pertaining to it and bearing a "Notice" of similar restrictions, is intended for use only in connection with procurement by the United States Government; and shall not be reproduced either wholly or in part except when authorized in connection with Government procurement nor be used for any other purpose except when specifically authorized by the Chief of Ordnance.

Custodian:
Army-Ordnance Corps.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T02:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.